P-H-001722A (GSA-FSS)
May 30, 1975
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. P-H-1722
October 17, 1974

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HAND CLEANER (PRE-MOISTENED PAD AND TOWELETTE; FOR INK AND OFFICE SOILS)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification P-H-1722, dated October 17, 1974.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of hand cleaner made of an absorbent material and pre-moistened with a cleansing solution (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. Hand cleaner shall be of the following types and classes (see 6.2):

Type I - Pad.
Type II - Towelette.
Class 1 - Individually packaged in foil packet.
Class 2 - Bulk packaged in plastic container.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

GG-B-60 - Ball Point Pen, Single Cartridge.
GG-M-114 - Marker, Tube Type, Felt Tip (Capillary-Action).
TT-I-556 - Ink, Stamp Pad.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks, and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards, from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

D 1122 - Specific Gravity of Engine Antifreeze by the Hydrometer.
D 1217 - Density and Specific Gravity of Liquids by Bingham Pycnometer.
D 3078 - Leaks in Heat-Sealed Flexible Packages.
E 70 - pH of Aqueous Solutions with the Glass Electrode.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Absorbent material.

3.1.1 Pads. Pads shall be made of cotton or synthetic fiber material. The weight of the material shall be not less than 94 grams per square meter. Pads shall be absorbent, white, of uniform composition, even edged, soft to the touch, clean, and shall not fray or separate during use.

3.1.2 Towelettes. Towelettes shall be made of high wet strength creped paper or synthetic fiber material. The weight of the towelette material shall be not less than 47 grams per square meter for paper towelettes, or 37 grams per square meter for synthetic fiber towelettes. Towelettes shall be absorbent, of uniform composition, even edged, soft to the touch, clean, and shall not fray or separate during use.

3.2 Cleansing solution. The cleansing solution shall consist of water, alcohol, detergent(s), humectant(s), mild perfume, and preservatives. Additional materials are permitted. The cleansing solution shall conform to the physical and chemical properties of table I. Alcohol and humectant(s) are not required for cleansing solution of type II, class 2 towelettes.

TABLE I. Physical and chemical requirements

Property	Minimum	Maximum
Specific gravity at 15.5°C	0.958	0.988
pH of 1:5 by volume dilution at 25°C	5.0	9.0

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3.2.1 Topical antibacterial agent. The cleansing solution shall contain benzalkonium chloride at a concentration of not less than 1.750.

3.3 Prohibited material. The finished product shall not contain methanol.

3.4 Non-staining of paper. Cleansing solution squeezed from the pad or towelette shall not stain white bond paper.

3.5 No grit or sticky film. The finished product shall not leave a gritty or sticky film on the hands after use.

3.6 Dermal irritation. The product shall not be irritating to the skin when tested as specified in 4.3.8.

3.7 Dimensions.

3.7.1 Pad. The pads shall be circular, with a diameter of not less than 2.875 inches.

3.7.2 Towelette. Class 1 towelettes shall have a length of not less than 7-1/2 inches and a width of not less than 5-5/16 inches. Class 2 towelettes shall be in a continuous sheet that feeds easily through the dispensing feature of the unit container (see 3.8) and is perforated so that the individual towelettes can be easily detached. Class 2 towelettes, when detached from the sheet, shall have a length of not less than 6-13/16 inches and a width of not less than 5-3/4 inches.

3.8 Unit container.

3.8.1 Type I. Fifty pads shall be saturated with cleansing solution and packaged in a reclosable plastic container with a tight fitting lid. A plastic bag or liner is required.

3.8.2 Type II, class 1. Each towelette shall be folded and packaged in a close-fitting water-vaporproof envelope. The envelope shall be made of a 3-ply laminated barrier material consisting of polyethylene film, dead soft aluminum foil, and super calendered pouch paper (components listed from inside out, respectively). The envelope shall be closed by heat sealing along the edges on all four sides. Each open side shall have a heat seal a minimum of 1/8 inch in width. Each side formed by a fold in the barrier material shall have a heat seal a minimum of 1/16 inch in width.

3.8.3 Type II, class 2. No less than 60 towelettes, in a continuous sheet, perforated so that each towelette can be detached from the sheet easily, shall be packaged in a plastic dispensing container with a tight-fitting, reclosable cover. The towelettes shall be sealed in a plastic bag, or the container shall have a vapor-proof seal to retard evaporation.

3.9 Leakage. Type II, class 1 envelopes (see 3.8.2) shall not show leakage when tested as specified in 4.3.5.

3.10 Accelerated aging. Type II, class 1 envelopes (see 3.8.2) shall show no delamination of the envelope material, no failure of the heat seals, nor shall any one lose more than 0.2 grams of weight when tested as specified in 4.3.4.

3.11 Weight of cleansing solution per unit container. The unit container shall contain not less than the following amount of cleansing solution at the time of first receipt by the Government:

Type I - 96 grams.
Type II, class 1 - 2.6 grams.
Type II, class 2 - 193 grams.

3.12 Performance. The product shall perform as specified in 4.3.7 in the removal of ink soils.

3.13 Shelf life. The pads or towelettes shall remain saturated with cleansing solution and the cleansing solution shall not lose its cleaning ability or damage the unit container during storage in unopened and undamaged containers (see 3.8) under general warehouse conditions at temperatures between 32°F and 135°F. The product will not spoil with mildew or discoloration.

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3.14 Certificate of compliance. The manufacturer shall certify that the product meets the requirements of 3.2, 3.2.1, 3.3, 3.6, and 3.13.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificates of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection.

4.2.1 Inspection of the end item. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all requirements of the referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless excluded, amended, or qualified in this specification or applicable contract or purchase documents. Where failure is reported, report description of failure or numerical point of failure, as appropriate.

4.2.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Packaging, packing, and marking shall be examined to determine compliance with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as in table II. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall consist of all shipping containers presented for delivery at one time. Sampling and acceptance shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2, acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE II. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Contents	Not as specified.
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of container. Cushioning inadequate, improper, or missing.

4.2.2.1 Examination of closure of shipping containers. When shipping containers are required to conform to PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

4.2.3 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined for defects as in table III. The sample unit shall be one unit container (as specified in 3.8). The lot shall consist of all hand cleaner of the same type and class manufactured during one 24-hour period, under the same processing conditions, using the same raw material lots and offered for delivery at one time. Sampling and acceptance shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-4, AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE III. Examination of the end item

Examine	Defect
Pad and towelette:	
Appearance	Not white (type I); mildewed; spoiled.
Texture	Not soft and absorbent.
Workmanship	Uneven or ragged edges; dirty; torn; breaks; slivers; shines; holes.
Dimensions	Less than specified.

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TABLE III. Examination of the end item (con.)

Examine	Defect
Unit container (see 3.8):	
Appearance	Not clean.
Labeling	Missing; incomplete; incorrect; or illegible.
Contents	Fewer pads or towelettes than specified.
Workmanship	Lid not tight fitting (as applicable); heat seal faulty or not as specified (as applicable); delamination of envelope (as applicable); no liner (as applicable); unit container cracked, broken, torn, or punctured; leakage of contents.

4.2.4 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested as specified in table IV. The sample unit shall be one (1) unit container for type I and type II, class 2 hand cleaner, and twenty (20) unit containers for type II, class 1 hand cleaner. The lot shall consist of all hand cleaner of the same type and class which has been made during one 24-hour period, from the same raw material lots, under the same processing conditions and offered for delivery at the same time. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-1. In addition to the sample units chosen above, sufficient unit containers (minimum of 3) shall be randomly selected from the lot to make up a composite sample of not less than 160 ml of cleansing solution for type II, class 1, or 400 ml for type I and type II, class 2, prepared as specified in 4.3.1. Failure of the composite sample or any sample unit to pass any of the specified tests shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE IV. Instructions for testing of the end item

Property	Specification Reference Requirement	Test Method	Results Reported Pass/Fail	To Nearest
Tests run on composite sample:				
Specific gravity	table I	4.3.3		0.002 unit
pH of 1:5 dilution	table I	4.3.2		0.1 pH unit
Weight of cleansing solution per unit container	3.11	4.3.1		0.1 gram
Weight of pad/towelette material	3.1	4.3.1		0.1 g/m^2
Tests run on sample units:				
Accelerated aging	3.10	4.3.4	X	
Leakage	3.9	4.3.5	X	
Non-staining of paper	3.4	4.3.6	X	
Performance	3.12	4.3.7	X	
Sticky or gritty film	3.5	4.3.7.3	X	
Fraying and separation	3.1	4.3.7.3	X	

4.3 Test procedures.

4.3.1 Collection of composite sample, weight of cleansing solution per unit container, and weight of pad or towelette material.

4.3.1.1 Weight of filled unit containers. Label the unit containers and weigh to the nearest 0.1 gram.

4.3.1.2 Collection of composite sample. Be sure to save all parts of the unit containers for reweighing in 4.3.1.3. Open unit container and squeeze contents over a funnel inserted in a glass container (with stopper). Remove funnel and stopper container to prevent loss of volatile material. Repeat the procedure until at least 160 ml of cleansing solution for type II, class 1 hand cleaner, or 400 ml of cleansing solution for type I and type II, class 2 hand cleaner has been collected.

4.3.1.3 Weight of cleansing solution per unit container. Open not less than 3 nor more than 10 unit containers used in 4.3.1.1 and dry to constant weight. Weigh unit containers and contents to the nearest 0.1 gram. Report loss of weight from that recorded in 4.3.1.1. Average loss in weight per unit container shall be reported as the weight of cleansing solution per unit container.

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4.3.1.4 Weight of pad or towelette material. Pads and towelettes shall be completely dry. Weigh a minimum of 10 pads or towelettes to the nearest 0.1 gram. Divide the average weight of a pad or towelette by the area of the pad or towelette in square meters. Report the average weight of the material in grams per square meter.

4.3.2 pH of 1:5 dilution. Dilute 10 ml of the composite sample with cool, freshly boiled, distilled water to a final volume of 50 ml. Measure the pH by ASTM Method E 70. Repeat the procedure and report the individual pH values and the average.

4.3.3 Specific gravity. Determine the specific gravity of the composite sample by ASTM Method D 1122 or ASTM Method D 1217.

4.3.4 Accelerated aging. Take 10 unit containers of type II, class 1 hand cleaner from the sample unit and weigh to the nearest 0.010 gram and place them in a circulating forced draft oven. Maintain at 60° + 2°C for 48 hours. Cool the envelopes in a dessicator and reweigh. Report the total weight lost and the average weight loss per packet. Inspect sample envelopes for delamination of envelope material and failure of heat-sealed edges.

4.3.5 Leakage. Examine five envelopes from the sample unit for leakage in accordance with ASTM Method D 3078-72 except that a vacuum of 25 mm of mercury shall be used and paragraphs 7.5, 7.6, and 8.2 shall not apply.

4.3.6 Staining of paper. Clean hands before test. Remove a pad or towelette from its container and squeeze three or four drops onto a clean sheet of white bond paper. Allow the cleansing solution to evaporate. The paper shall not be stained or discolored.

4.3.7 Performance.

4.3.7.1 Standard test soils. The standard test soils shall consist of:

Test soil A: Ball point pen ink: GG-B-60, black ink.
Test soil B: Felt tip marker ink: GG-M-114, black ink.
Test soil C: Stamp pad ink: TT-I-556, class 1, black.

4.3.7.2 Application of test soils.

4.3.7.2.1 Test soil A. Rub pen on a piece of paper to start ink flowing. Make four lines, each one inch long, on the palm of the hand.

4.3.7.2.2 Test soil B. Rub marker on the palm of the hand until a circular area of the palm, one inch in diameter, has been covered with ink.

4.3.7.2.3 Test soil C. Place some ink on a piece of paper. Touch a finger to the ink and rub the finger over the palm of the hand until a circular area of the palm, one inch in diameter, has been covered with ink.

4.3.7.3 Performance testing. Take one pad or towelette and rub the soiled area of the hand briskly for one minute, turning the pad or towelette over during use. Observe if the pad or towelette separates or unravels during use. The pad or towelette should remove all the ink soil from the ridges of the hand and most of the soil from the creases of the skin. Take a second pad or towelette and rub the soiled hand for one minute. Soil should be removed from the hand. A few traces of soil are allowed to remain in the creases of the skin. Allow the hand to dry thoroughly. The hand should not feel sticky or gritty. Press the hand firmly, palm down, on a sheet of white paper. Lift the hand slowly. The paper should not adhere even slightly to the hand. No traces of ink stain should be left on the paper. Rub the hand with a white towel. No ink stain should be left on the towel.

4.3.8 Dermal irritation. The product shall be tested by no fewer than six men and six women. Each person shall rub both hands firmly and thoroughly with one fresh pad or towelette three times a day, five days a week, for 2 weeks. After each use, the person shall wait at least 1 hour before washing the hands. The product shall not cause irritation to the hands of any of the 12 people.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level B.

5.1.1.1 Unit container. For this specification, the unit container shall be as specified in 3.8.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate container. The number of unit containers specified in table V shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, or in a box normally used by the industry. The box shall be closed to prevent accidental opening.

TABLE V. Quantity per container

Description	Unit containers per intermediate container	Intermediate containers per shipping container
Type I	12	6 (72 unit containers)
Type II, class 1	50	20 (1,000 unit containers)
Type II, class 2	6	4 (24 unit containers)

5.1.2 Level C. The unit containers specified in 3.8 shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving agency.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level B shipping container. The number of intermediate containers specified in table V shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level C. Unit containers (as specified in 3.8), packaged as specified in 5.1.2, in quantities as specified (see 6.2), shall be packed in containers to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination. Containers shall comply with Uniform Freight or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit container. The unit container shall be labeled or marked with name or trade name of contents, name or trademark of manufacturer, number of pads or towelettes per container, and other regular commercial marking with current appropriate materials and procedures.

5.3.2 Intermediate and shipping container. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the intermediate and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of Fed. Std. No. 123.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The hand cleaning pads and towelettes covered by this specification are intended for use in removing ink and office type soils from the hands without the use of soap and water.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class required (see 1.2).
(c) Quantity required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Marking document required (see 5.3).

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price cents each.

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